



**RESEARCH / PROJECT ETHICS REVIEW FORM**  
**For Thesis / Capstone / Dissertation Proposals**  
*(ver.Oct2024c)*

**Names of Student Researcher(s):**

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**Research/Thesis/Capstone Title:** To Predict Is To Believe: Integrating Content, Context, and Creator Features For Pre-Publication Short-Form Video Engagement Prediction

**College:** College of Computer Studies

**Department:** Department of Software Technology

**Course:** Bachelor of Science in Computer Science Major in Software Technology

**Expected Duration of the Project:** from: Mar 25, 2026 to Apr 16, 2027

**PROTOCOL:**

*(To be filled up by proponents; Use the Ethics Checklists as guides in determining areas for ethical concern/consideration. Attach and properly reference the accomplished ethics checklists and supporting documents.)*

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Reference Document<br>(include page number)                     |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Target participants         | Active TikTok content creators who have a professional or business account. Participants must be at least 18 years old and have a consistent posting history (e.g., minimum of 3 videos per week over the last 6 months).                                                                                   | Section 3.1.1: Data Acquisition and Collection Procedure, pg 14 |
| Data to be used / collected | Data to be Used / Collected <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Multimodal Content: Raw MP4 video files, captions, and hashtags.</li><li>- Creator Metadata: Follower count, following count, and account age.</li><li>- Contextual Data: Specific posting timestamps and content categories.</li></ul> | Section 3.1.2: Dataset Variables and Metrics (Table 3.2), pg 15 |
| Brief procedure             | <ol style="list-style-type: none"><li>1. Consent: Participants sign a digital agreement after reviewing the research objectives.</li><li>2. Export &amp; Creators generate an official "Download your data" archive from their TikTok settings.</li></ol>                                                   | Section 3.1.1: Table 3.1 (Step-by-Step Data Acquisition), pg 14 |

|                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                             | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>3. Submission: Creators upload the archive and raw MP4 files to a secure, encrypted cloud portal.</li> <li>4. Anonymization: Researchers strip all personal identifiers and replace creator handles with alphanumeric IDs.</li> <li>5. Verification: Researchers cross-reference timestamps to map engagement metrics to the video files.</li> </ol> |                                                               |
| Potential risks                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Privacy Breach: Risk of re-identification if metadata is linked to a public profile.</li> <li>- Data Misuse: Risk of raw video files being used for purposes outside this specific research.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                            | Section 3.1.3: Ethical Safeguards and Limitations, pg 16      |
| Applicable Terms of Use or Licensing Agreement of Data, Models and/or Tools | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- TikTok Terms of Service: Data collection is compliant as it is user-initiated (Data Donation) rather than automated scraping.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Section 3.1.3: Ethical Safeguards and Limitations, pg 16      |
| Steps to safeguard the participants and/or data                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- De-identification: All usernames, profile pictures, and handles are removed immediately after collection.</li> <li>- Right to Withdraw: Participants can request the deletion of their donated data at any time before the final model aggregation.</li> </ul>                                                                                     | Section 3.1.3: De-identification and Storage Protocols, pg 16 |
| Other concerns and considerations                                           | N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                               |

#### PANEL'S ASSESSMENT/COMMENTS:

#### PANEL'S DECISION:

- € **Approved** (*Proponent/s may proceed with the study/data collection*)
- € **Modifications Required** (*Proponent/s should address ethical issues, follow the panel's recommendations for required modifications, and resubmit Ethics Review Form for approval before proceeding with the study or before starting with data collection*)
- € **For Full Review** (*Proponent/s should submit the proposal to the University Research Ethics Review Committee (RERC) and obtain a research ethics clearance before proceeding with the study or before starting with data collection*)

JUSTIFICATION:

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**Name and Signature of Adviser/Mentor**

**Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

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**Name and Signature of Panel Member**

**Name and Signature of Panel Member**

**Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

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**Name and Signature of Panel Member**

**Date:** \_\_\_\_\_